Lorde continued to travel to Berlin, for sustenance and treatments. She opened her poem “Restoration: A Memorial—9/18/91” by writing, “Berlin again after chemotherapy / I reach behind me once more / for days to come.”[36] In September 1992, Lorde traveled to Berlin and gave a public reading once more in Schultz’s apartment. For Lorde, a prolific and widely published poet, revision not only nourished her work toward refinement and revelation, but also allowed her to remain situated firmly within the creative process throughout her life. Documented and brought forward in a bonus clip from Schultz’s film *Audre Lorde: The Berlin Years*, Lorde is shown seated by a table with a vase of sunflowers and an open notebook from which she reads her poem “1984,” which also happens to be the year of her first visit to Berlin. She provides some historical context about the poem in which she imagines she becomes president of the United States, noting that she was inspired to revise U.S. power relations from George Orwell’s vision of 1984. Moreover, this poem, like many of her others, began with a spark of a dream, inspired by thoughtful slumber during one April 4, the anniversary of the assassination of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. But before she read she also reminded her listeners that this was a work-in-progress: “Now I really want some feedback about this poem. Because it’s a dream and I feel different ways about it at different times.”[37] Here and across Berlin’s historical divides, open spaces, and hiding places, Lorde sought connection and a perch from which to reside within her creative process of writing poetry. Her call to revision was spurred on by her dreams of and in the city. Two months after this trip to Berlin, in November 1992, Lorde passed away in her home in Saint Croix after a prolonged fight with cancer.

For months and years after her death, friends, loved ones, and those inspired by her teachings held memorials—at the Haus der Kulturen der Welt (House of the Cultures of the World) in Berlin, at the Cathedral Church of Saint John the Divine in New York, and near her and Gloria Joseph’s home in Saint Croix, among other locales. Lorde’s biographer Alexis De Veaux captures the immediate forms of memorial Lorde had envisioned: “Lorde had spent a lifetime defying socially imposed boundaries and she wanted her ashes scattered in several places.”[38] Lorde’s final resting places include Buck Island in Saint Croix, a site in Hawaii from which she had seen an eclipse, her former yard in Staten Island, Washington Square Park in her hometown of New York City, and by Krumme Lanke, the lake she loved in the former West Berlin.